



AI SEO Mastery Pro [Start ...

0%

Getting Started



SEO Foundation



Setting Up Your AI



Local SEO Foundations



How to Do Local AI SEO



The Google Business Pr...



Creating AI Content



Building a Core 30 Web...



Starting Off-Site AI SEO



Optimizing for AI Syste...



Special Circumstances



YMYL-Niche Sites

Ethics: E-E-A-T Authorship ...

When to Use a Sitemap

NoFollow Attributes on Links

Hiding Content from Users

Disavowing Existing Backlin...

Non-Local SEO



Non-Local SEO Engagement Plan

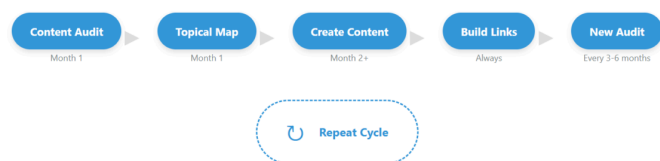


5:16

Non-Local SEO Engagement Plan

When managing ongoing SEO engagements for non-local clients, success comes from a systematic approach that builds topical authority over time. This lesson combines the strategic framework for ongoing engagements with the specific tactics that drive results in non-local SEO.

Non-Local SEO Process



Month 1: Foundation

The first month with any new client begins with a comprehensive content audit to identify low-hanging fruit—content opportunities that can rank relatively quickly with minimal effort. This audit becomes your roadmap for the months ahead.



Basic Site Structure

Search Console for Existing ...

Click Through Rate (CTR) A...

Identify Content with Existin...

Generate Topical Relevance

Keyword Research Philosop...

AI-Generate Keyword Variati...

Creating a Content Planner

AI-Rewriting Pages

Months 2+: Execution and Expansion

In subsequent months, we continue working through the targets identified in the initial audit. There's no need to redo the audit immediately; instead, we systematically tackle different targets based on the client's scope of work and budget.

Every 3-6 Months: Reassessment

Regular content audits every three to six months serve multiple purposes:

- Identify new ranking opportunities
- Assess the performance of previously optimized content
- Discover content that has moved closer to page one
- Ensure a continuous pipeline of valuable work



Key Principle: As the site gains authority and rankings improve, each subsequent audit reveals more opportunities, creating a cycle of growth.

When to Use Topical Relevance Maps

- Working with **non-local businesses** (e-commerce, SaaS, national services)
- The client needs to establish **subject matter authority**
- Geographic location is **not** a primary ranking factor
- You're building content for **national or global audiences**

Skip Topical Maps for Local SEO:

- Local businesses focus on **geographic relevance** instead (though they may need topical relevance *as well*.)

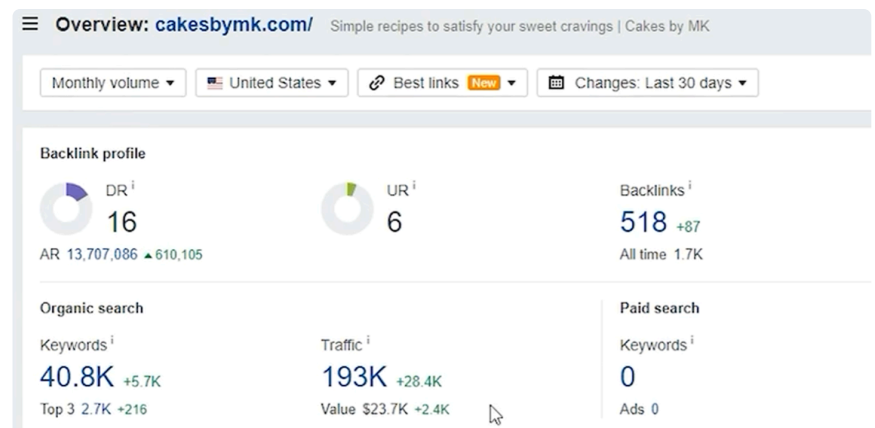


- The primary goal is ranking in specific geographic areas

Important Distinction: Local SEO relies on geographic authority and local signals. Non-local SEO requires comprehensive topical coverage to establish expertise in a subject area.

The Power of Topical Relevance

For non-local SEO, topical relevance is the cornerstone of modern search success. Unlike local SEO where geographic relevance matters most, non-local sites must establish themselves as comprehensive authorities in their subject matter.



Case Study: Cakes by MK

Consider this remarkable example:

- **Domain Rating:** 16 (quite low)
- **Monthly Traffic:** 200,000 visitors
- **Ranking Keywords:** 41,000
- **Total Articles:** 212 published articles about cakes

This site demonstrates that domain authority isn't everything—topical depth can overcome traditional metrics.



1. Create a Topical Relevance Map

Before any content creation begins, map out the entire topical landscape of your client's industry. This differs from traditional keyword research—it's about understanding every aspect of the topic your client needs to cover.

Topical maps can be done simultaneously with your first content audit, or they can be done in the second or third month, depending on how large your clients' site is.

Note: While keyword research can be valuable, a topical relevance map is non-negotiable for non-local sites. It ensures comprehensive coverage of your client's subject area.

2. Generate Comprehensive Content Ideas

Your topical relevance map should yield hundreds of content opportunities. **If you have a content audit, you can map these to existing pages on your clients' site and see where there are gaps.** The goal is to demonstrate to Google that your client is the definitive resource in their space.

3. Systematic Content Production

Use the AI content generation methods covered in our content creation section, but remember:

- Never publish AI content directly without human editing
- Each piece should fill a specific gap in your topical coverage
- Quality matters—rushed, unedited content won't achieve results

4. Build Authority Through Links



negotiable—skipping it renders your content efforts ineffective.

**Related Lessons:**

[\[Done-For-You\] Basic Backlinking
Searching for Link Opportunities](#)

5. Analyze Competition

When evaluating content opportunities, check the SERP overview to understand:

- Domain ratings of ranking sites
- The depth of content required to compete
- Opportunities where topical relevance can overcome domain authority

Ongoing Optimization Strategy

The beauty of this approach lies in its simplicity and scalability:

1. **Publish** high-quality, topically relevant content
2. **Optimize** internal linking to strengthen topical clusters
3. **Secure** external links to validate content quality
4. **Move** to the next target
5. **Repeat** the process consistently

As you continue this cycle, each piece of content makes the entire site more authoritative and comprehensive in Google's eyes.

Scaling Your Efforts

Once you've exhausted your initial topical relevance map:

- Generate additional related topics in adjacent spaces



variations

- Update and expand successful pieces to maintain freshness

i Remember: The sites that win in non-local SEO aren't necessarily those with the highest domain authority—they're the ones that most comprehensively cover their topic area with quality, well-linked content.

Key Takeaways

- Start every engagement with a content audit to find quick wins
- Repeat audits every 3-6 months to maintain momentum
- **Topical relevance maps are for non-local SEO only**—local businesses use different strategies
- Every piece of content needs external validation through links
- Consistency and comprehensiveness create compound results over time

By following this systematic approach, you'll build sustainable, long-term value for your non-local SEO clients while maintaining a clear, repeatable process that scales with your agency.